

Word family: **dress / dresses / dressed / dressing / dresser / dressy / undress**

Base word: dress

Forms: dresses, dressed, dressing

Related forms: dresser, dressy, undress, undressed

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞) / related noun and adjective forms (相關名詞及形容詞)

Your sentence:

> “I can throw it on over a T-shirt, a shirt, or even a simple **dress**...”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **dress** is a noun meaning a **one-piece item of clothing that covers the body from the shoulders or upper body downward, typically worn as outer clothing**.

繁體中文： **連身裙**；由上身延伸至下身、作為一件完整衣服穿著的服裝

中文翻譯：

> “...over a T-shirt, a shirt, or even a simple **dress**...”

「.....披在 T 恤、襯衫，甚至一條簡單的**連身裙**外面.....」

Here:

a simple dress = 一條款式簡單的連身裙

1. **dress = one-piece garment (衣服) — 連身裙；洋裝**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: A one-piece garment covering the upper body and extending downward over the legs.

Practice 1 — Original

> “I can wear the jacket over a simple **dress**.”

「我可以把外套穿在一條簡單的**連身裙**外面。」

Practice 2

> “She wore a long blue ****dress****.”

「她穿了一條藍色長****連身裙****。」

Practice 3

> “I bought a summer ****dress**** for the trip.”

「我為這次旅行買了一條夏季****連身裙****。」

****dress** = 一件從上身延伸到下身的完整衣服，通常指連身裙******

Common:

- * long dress
- * summer dress
- * evening dress
- * wedding dress
- * casual dress

2. ****dress** = clothing/style of clothing generally (服裝) — 衣着；服裝方式******

****Dress**** can also mean clothing generally, especially the style or type of clothing people wear.

Practice 4

> “Traditional ****dress**** varies from region to region.”

「不同地區的傳統****服飾****各有不同。」

Practice 5

> “The event requires formal ****dress****.”

「這個場合要求穿着正式****服裝****。」

****dress** = 某人 / 群體所穿的服裝類型或整體衣着方式******

Common:

- * traditional dress
- * formal dress
- * national dress
- * style of dress

This is genuinely different from **a dress** = 一條連身裙.

3. **dress** = put clothes on yourself (動詞) — 穿衣 ; 穿好衣服

As a verb, **dress** can mean to put clothes on yourself.

Practice 6

> “I got up and **dressed** quickly.”

「我起床後很快就**穿好衣服**。」

Practice 7

> “She was still **dressing** when I called.”

「我打電話時，她還在**穿衣服**。」

dress = 把衣服穿到自己身上

This verb can be intransitive:

> “He **dressed**.”

= 他穿好了衣服。

4. **dress** = put clothes on someone else (替某人穿衣) — 替.....穿衣

Dress can also be transitive.

Practice 8

> “She **dressed** the child for school.”

「她替孩子**穿好衣服**準備上學。」

Practice 9

> “He needed help to **dress** himself.”

「他需要有人幫忙才能**自己穿衣**。」

****dress someone = 替某人把衣服穿好****

This is the transitive counterpart of Meaning 3.

5. ****dress = wear clothes in a particular style (穿着打扮) — 穿着 ; 打扮****

****Dress**** can mean choosing or wearing a particular type or style of clothing.

Practice 10

> “She always ****dresses**** elegantly.”

「她總是****穿着得很優雅****。」

Practice 11

> “He was ****dressed in**** black.”

「他****穿着****一身黑色。」

****dress = 以某種風格、顏色或正式程度來穿着打扮****

Common:

- * dress casually
- * dress formally
- * dress smartly
- * dress in black
- * dress for the occasion

For strict counting, this is closely related to Meaning 3, but learner-facing separation is useful.

6. ****dress = put formal/special clothes on (盛裝) — 穿正式服裝 ; 打扮****

In some constructions, ****dress**** specifically suggests dressing appropriately or formally for an occasion.

Practice 12

> “You don’t need to ****dress**** for dinner.”

「晚餐時你不需要特別**盛裝打扮**。」

Practice 13

> “Everyone was beautifully **dressed**.”

「大家都**打扮得很漂亮**。」

This is an extension of the clothing verb rather than a separate core meaning.

7. **dress = cover a wound with bandages/medical material (醫療) — 包紮 ; 敷治**

This is an important medical sense.

Practice 14

> “The nurse cleaned and **dressed** the wound.”

「護士清潔並**包紮**了傷口。」

Practice 15

> “The cut should be **dressed** daily.”

「這個傷口應每天重新**敷治 / 包紮**。」

****dress a wound = 清潔傷口並用紗布、敷料等覆蓋保護****

This is genuinely distinct from clothing.

8. **dress = add sauce/seasoning to food (烹飪) — 拌 ; 調味**

****Dress** can mean adding a sauce, oil, seasoning, etc. to food, especially salad.**

Practice 16

> “**Dress** the salad just before serving.”

「上桌前才把沙拉**拌上醬汁 / 調味**。」

Practice 17

> “The vegetables were lightly ****dressed**** with olive oil.”

「蔬菜只用少量橄欖油****調味 / 拌勻****。」

****dress food** = 在食物表面加上醬汁、油或其他調味料******

This is the source of the noun ****dressing**** in:

> salad dressing

9. ****dress** = prepare meat, fish, or an animal for cooking/use (處理食材) — 處理；宰後整理******

In food preparation, ****dress**** can mean preparing fish, poultry, or an animal carcass by cleaning and removing unwanted parts.

Practice 18

> “The fish was cleaned and ****dressed**** before cooking.”

「那條魚在烹煮前已清理並****處理好****。」

Practice 19

> “The birds were ****dressed**** for the kitchen.”

「那些禽鳥已經****處理好****供烹調。」

****dress** = 把魚、肉或禽類整理、清潔，準備烹調******

This is established but more specialized than the clothing sense.

10. ****dress** = shape/finish a material such as stone or timber (工藝) — 修整；加工******

In building, stonework, woodworking, etc., ****dress**** can mean cutting, smoothing, or finishing a material.

Practice 20

> “The stone was carefully ****dressed**** before construction.”

「石材在施工前經過仔細****修整 / 加工****。」

Practice 21

> “The timber was ****dressed**** to produce a smooth surface.”

「木材經過****刨平加工****，形成光滑表面。」

****dress material = 修整表面或形狀，使材料適合使用****

This is a genuine specialist sense.

11. ****dress = arrange/decorate something for display (展示 / 場景) — 佈置；裝飾****

****Dress**** can mean arranging or decorating something to make it presentable.

Practice 22

> “The shop window was ****dressed**** for the holiday season.”

「商店櫥窗為節日季節作了****佈置****。」

Practice 23

> “The film crew ****dressed**** the set to look like an old apartment.”

「電影工作人員把佈景****佈置成****舊式公寓的樣子。」

****dress a window/set = 佈置、裝飾，使其達到特定視覺效果****

This is an important visual/design extension.

12. ****dress = arrange troops in alignment (軍事，專門) — 整隊；對齊隊列****

In military drill, ****dress**** can mean aligning yourself or a formation with others.

Example:

> “The soldiers dressed the line.”

「士兵把隊列****對齊 / 整隊****。」

Related command:

> dress right

This is legitimate but clearly specialist, so I would keep it outside the everyday core.

Related form: ****dressing****

****Dressing**** has several important meanings of its own.

****dressing = act/process of putting on clothes (穿衣) ****

> “Dressing took longer than usual.”

「今天****穿衣服****花了比平常更長時間。」

****dressing = wound covering (醫療敷料) — 敷料；繃帶材料****

Practice 24

> “The nurse changed the ****dressing****.”

「護士更換了傷口****敷料****。」

****dressing = 覆蓋傷口的紗布、繃帶或其他醫療材料****

****dressing = sauce for salad/food (沙律醬) — 醬汁；調味汁****

Practice 25

> “Would you like dressing on your salad?”

「你的沙律要加****沙律醬 / 調味汁****嗎？」

Common:

- * salad dressing
- * French dressing
- * creamy dressing

This is an important lexicalized noun.

Related form: **dresser**

Dresser has several meanings.

dresser = person who dresses someone (服裝工作人員)

In theatre, film, fashion, etc., a **dresser** can be someone who helps performers change or put on costumes.

> “The actor’s dresser prepared the costume.”

「演員的**服裝助理**準備好了戲服。」

dresser = furniture for storing clothes (家具，美式常見) — 衣櫃式抽屜櫃；梳妝櫃

Practice 26

> “She put the shirts in the **dresser**.”

「她把襯衫放進**抽屜櫃**裡。」

In AmE, a **dresser** is commonly a chest of drawers, often used for clothing.

dresser = kitchen sideboard/cupboard (英式傳統) — 餐具櫃

In British English, especially traditional usage, a **dresser** can mean a kitchen cupboard/sideboard with shelves for plates.

This is a separate lexicalized furniture sense.

Related form: **dressy**

Dressy means relatively formal, stylish, or suitable for a smarter occasion.

Practice 27

> “The restaurant is quite **dressy**.”

「這間餐廳的衣着氣氛比較**正式 / 講究**。」

Practice 28

> “She chose a **dressy** blouse.”

「她選了一件較**華麗 / 正式**的上衣。」

dressy = 比日常休閒服裝更正式、講究或漂亮的**

Related form: **undress**

Undress means to remove clothes.

Practice 29

> “He **undressed** and went to bed.”

「他**脫掉衣服**後上床睡覺。」

It is a useful opposite-family form, although semantically it has become its own lexical item.

Important distinction: **dress vs clothes**

dress

can mean:

* one specific garment: a dress

* general style/type of clothing: formal dress

clothes

means garments generally.

> “She bought some clothes.”

not normally:

> “She bought some dress.” ❌

unless **dress** means a style/category:

> formal dress

Important distinction: **dress vs gown**

dress

is the broad everyday term.

gown

usually suggests a more specialized garment, such as:

- * evening gown
- * wedding gown
- * academic gown
- * hospital gown

A gown is often longer or more formal/specialized.

Important distinction: **dress vs skirt**

dress

covers both upper and lower body as one garment.

skirt

covers only the lower body.

So:

- > dress = 連身裙
- > skirt = 半截裙 / 裙

Important distinction: **dress vs wear**

wear

means have clothing on your body.

> “She wears black.”

dress

focuses more on putting clothes on or choosing a style.

> “She dresses in black.”

The second often describes habitual style.

Important distinction: **dress vs put on**

put on

focuses on the action of placing a particular item of clothing onto your body.

> “Put on your jacket.”

dress

means getting clothed more generally.

> “Get dressed.”

You can:

> put on a shirt

but normally not:

> dress a shirt ❌

Important distinction: **dressed vs wearing**

dressed in blue

= 穿着藍色衣服 / 以藍色打扮

wearing blue

= 正穿着藍色衣服

****Dressed**** often describes the overall appearance or state; ****wearing**** simply reports what is on the body.

Important distinction: ****dress a wound vs cover a wound****

****cover****

simply means put something over it.

****dress****

in medical use includes appropriate wound care, usually cleaning/protective material.

So ****dress a wound**** is a specialized procedure, not merely “cover it.”

Grammar note: ****dress / get dressed****

A very important learner distinction:

****dress****

> “She dressed quickly.”

= 她很快穿好衣服。

****get dressed****

> “I need to get dressed.”

= 我要穿衣服了。

****Get dressed**** is especially common in everyday speech.

Grammar note: ****dress someone / dress yourself****

Transitive

> “She dressed the baby.”

Reflexive

> “He dressed himself.”

Intransitive

> “She dressed quickly.”

All are standard.

Grammar note: **dress in / dress for / dress as**

dress in + colour/style

> dress in black

= 穿黑色衣服

dress for + occasion/weather

> dress for the weather

= 按天氣穿衣

dress as + person/role

> dress as a pirate

= 打扮成海盜

These are useful grammatical patterns, not separate meanings.

Countability note

dress = garment

Countable:

> a dress

> two dresses

dress = clothing/style generally

Usually uncountable:

- > formal dress
- > traditional dress

That distinction is very useful.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* **dress**
* **dresses**
* **dressed**
* **dressing**
* **dresser**
* **dressy**
* **undress**

The family has a broader semantic spread than the target noun might suggest. A proper second-pass sweep needs to catch not just clothing but also:

- * wound care
- * food preparation
- * material finishing
- * visual/display arrangement

The SOP requires these established modern domain uses to be surfaced first and then merged only where the underlying mental concept genuinely remains the same.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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dress — garment	一件由上身延伸到下身的連身衣服；連身裙 / 洋裝
dress — clothing generally	某種場合、群體或文化的整體衣着 / 服裝方式
dress — put clothes on yourself	穿衣服、穿好衣服
dress someone	替某人穿衣
dress — style oneself	按某種風格、顏色或正式程度穿着打扮
dress a wound	清潔並用敷料 / 繃帶包紮傷口
dress food	在食物上加醬汁、油或調味料
dress fish/meat	把魚、禽肉等清理並處理好供烹調
dress stone/timber	修整、切削或加工材料表面

dress a window/set	為櫥窗、舞台、電影場景等作視覺佈置	
dressing — wound	傷口敷料	
dressing — food	沙律醬 / 調味汁	
dresser — person	幫演員 / 模特兒穿換服裝的人	
dresser — furniture	抽屜衣櫃 / 餐具櫃，依英美語境而異	
dressy	較正式、漂亮、講究的	
undress	脫衣服	

For your original sentence

> “I can throw it on over a T-shirt, a shirt, or even a simple ****dress****...”

The exact meaning is:

****dress = 一件完整覆蓋上身和部分 / 全部下身的連身裙****

So:

> ****a simple dress****

= ****一條簡單款式的連身裙****

For your database, I would count ****7 genuinely useful core meanings for `dress`****:

1. ****noun — one-piece garment****
2. ****noun — clothing/style of dress generally****
3. ****verb — put clothes on oneself/someone / dress in a particular way****
4. ****verb — medically treat and cover a wound****
5. ****verb — add sauce/seasoning to food****
6. ****verb — prepare fish/meat/poultry for cooking****
7. ****verb — prepare/finish/arrange something for use or display****, covering established uses such as ****dress stone/timber**** and ****dress a window/set****

I would keep military alignment as a lower-priority specialist extension, and keep ****dressing / dresser / dressy / undress**** as family extensions rather than inflate the base count.